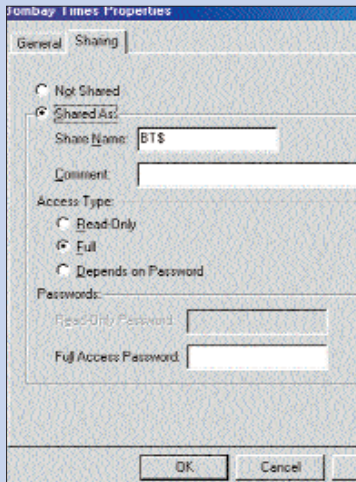




Create a folder, and give it write permissions.

/etc/squid directory. Open this file in a text editor such as vi, and find the line under the ADMINISTRATIVE PARAMETERS section that says:

visible_hostname

Change it to visible_hostname digit

Assuming you want your proxy server to be called 'digit', you now need to set the access permissions in this configuration file.

Scroll down to OPTIONS FOR EXTERNAL SUPPORT PROGRAMS, and locate '# TAG http_access.' Just before this line, add the IPs of the computers that can access this proxy server. For example, if you want to

allow access to 192.168.0.2, add the following:

acl friend src 192.168.0.2

Here, 'friend' is an alias. You'll use this alias in the next step while setting up permissions. Scroll down and find the line that says 'INSERT YOUR OWN RULE(S) TO ALLOW ACCESS FROM YOUR CLIENTS,' and add the following:

http_access allow friend

This line needs to be above 'http_access deny all'. Now, save the file, and start Squid by typing in 'squid'.

Next, you need to set up firewall rules. The simplest way to do this is to use the **setup** command, if you are running Red Hat. Otherwise, you will have to use 'iptables'. For more details on this, refer to 'Lock and Load Linux' in the April 2004 issue of *Digit* on page 102.

Once you're done with the setup, you'll need to specify the proxy settings on the other computers before you can browse the Internet. Open Internet Explorer, go to **Tools > Internet Options**, and switch to the Connections tab. Then, click the LAN Settings button, and specify the proxy server address as 192.168.0.2 and 3128 as the port. Here, the IP we've specified is that of the computer where Squid is installed.

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Experimenting with stuff

Most organisations don't seem to like popular IM clients such as MSN Messenger. Setting up a chat client for a local network, such as Jabber and IRC Daemon, is an ideal solution. For details, refer to the May 2004 issue of *Digit*, on page 136.

One of the best uses you can put your old computer to is to experiment with stuff you're not sure about. You can install Linux, play around with partitions, re-compile the kernel, and so on. It's also fun to use old computers for command-line tools: get a C compiler and learn C the old way.

We said it before and we'll say it again—there's lots of things you can do with your old *dabba*. Use your imagination—you have nothing to lose! 